Fuentebella found illustrating the epic finale keyframes to be challenging. "I wanted the battle to feel like massive forces are engaging in a life-and-death struggle," he says. "I looked at films of ship battles, various war scenes, and large animals fighting for territorial rights in order to get the feel of this visceral scene of destruction."

The Visual Effects team looked to reference, as well. "We wanted to ground a flying aircraft carrier in reality as much as possible," Visual Effects Supervisor Dan DeLeeuw says. "The guns are tri-barreled. Each barrel fires slightly offset from each other. One of the biggest challenges was to track the damage on each Helicarrier throughout the battle. We used the position of the Helicarriers to determine which one had the best tactical position. As a result, the Helicarrier that is lowest received the most damage. By working from the post-vis, ILM was able to map the damage from every gun. This damage remains consistent through the battle until the Helicarriers ultimately crash."

Rodney Fuentebella concept art.